One War Many Narratives

A Multi-Layer Text Analysis of Media Framing of the Iran-Israel Conflict, 2026

Submitted as part of course fulfilment project in the subject

Text and Web Analytics

As part of the

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

By

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Under the guidance of

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SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER LEARNING

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that this Project titled "**One War Many Narratives: A Multi-Layer Analysis of the Iran-Israel Conflict 2026"** submitted by **S Adithya**, roll number **24030302038**, Department of Management & Commerce, Brindavan Campus, is a bona fide record of the original work done under my supervision.

Signature of Supervisor
Sri L K Prasad Rayaprolu

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 04.04.2026

DECLARATION

I hereby declare that this project titled "**One War Many Narratives: A Multi-Layer Analysis of the Iran-Israel Conflict 2026"** submitted to **Sri Sathya Sai Institute of Higher Learning (Brindavan Campus),** was carried out by me under the supervision of Sri L K Prasad Rayaprolu, Department of Management & Commerce, Brindavan Campus as a Course completion project.

I further declare that this work has not been submitted previously for the award of any degree of diploma in any university or institution.

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Place: Bengaluru
Date: 04.04.2026

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Executive Summary

This project presents a comprehensive, multi-layer text analytics study of the Iran–Israel conflict of 2026, employing nine distinct analytical techniques across three independent data layers: 699 news articles from 29 outlets spanning 6 geopolitical perspectives (Layer 1), 232 editorial and opinion pieces from 5 outlets (Layer 2), and 1,681 YouTube comments from 48 channels (Layer 3). The corpus totals 2,602 documents collected between 22 February and 24 March 2026.

The central research question - whether the same conflict produces fundamentally different narratives across geopolitical perspectives, and whether public discourse echoes or diverges from media framing - is answered affirmatively and quantitatively.

Key findings include:

- **Narrative Divergence:** Text classification achieves 62.6% accuracy on news and 86.2% on editorials (vs. 20% random baseline), confirming measurable, distinct linguistic fingerprints per perspective.
- **Negativity Gradient:** News: −0.639 → Editorials: −0.505 → YouTube: −0.132. Public discourse is 4.9× less negative than institutional news.
- **Universal Peace Deficit:** Diplomacy coverage: 2.0% (news), 4.3% (editorials), 0.0% (YouTube). The word "peace" appears 0.5 times per 100 news articles.
- **Structural Isolation:** Israeli news outlets cluster at hierarchical distance 0.90 from all others - the most isolated perspective in the corpus.
- **Public Discourse Divergence:** YouTube introduces religious, conspiratorial, and moral-accusation framing entirely absent from institutional media.

The project maps to SDG 16 (Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions), SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities), and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals).

Introduction & Approach

Key Question Answered

"Does the same conflict produce fundamentally different narratives across geopolitical perspectives - and does public discourse echo or diverge from media framing?"

The Iran–Israel conflict of 2026 provides a near-ideal natural experiment for media framing analysis: a single, globally significant event covered simultaneously by outlets across ideologically and geographically diverse perspectives. This study applies a full suite of text analytics methodologies to quantify, compare, and interpret these narrative differences across three distinct discourse layers.

Analytical Framework

Layer	Dataset	Documents	Perspectives	Period
1 - News Articles	News_Articles.csv	699	6 (South Asian, Western, Arab/ME, Turkish, Russian, Israeli)	Feb 22 – Mar 23, 2026
2 - Opinion/Editorials	News_Public_Opinion.csv	232	5 (Israeli absent - pre-war)	Feb 22 – Mar 24, 2026
3 - YouTube Comments	Youtube_Comments.csv	1,681	4 (US/Western, South Asian, Israeli-aligned, Intl.)	Mar 9 – Mar 24, 2026
TOTAL	-	2,602	-	-

Analytical Techniques Applied

Nine analytical phases were applied across all three data layers: (1) Data Loading & Preprocessing, (2) VADER Sentiment Analysis, (3) Descriptive Text Analytics - Word Clouds, N-grams, TF-IDF, KWIC, (4) Topic Modelling - LDA & LSA, (5) Clustering - K-Means & Hierarchical, (6) Named Entity Recognition (NER), (7) Text Classification, (8) Extractive Summarization, and (9) Network Analysis (Layer 3 only).

Layer 1 - News Articles Analysis

The news article corpus comprises 699 articles from 29 outlets across 6 geopolitical perspectives. After deduplication and quality filtering (minimum 10 tokens, post-war date), text preprocessing involved tokenisation, lemmatisation, and a 3-tier custom stopword set (NLTK base + domain + outlet-specific) totalling 500+ stopwords.

VADER Sentiment Analysis

VADER (Valence Aware Dictionary and Sentiment Reasoner) was applied to raw, unprocessed article text to preserve emotional cues such as punctuation, capitalisation, and intensifiers. VADER outputs a compound score in [−1, +1].

Metric	Value	Interpretation
Mean Compound Score	−0.639	Deeply negative on average
Median Compound Score	−0.917	Typical article is intensely negative
Std. Deviation	0.563	High variation driven by minority positive articles
% Negative	84.3%	Overwhelming negativity
% Positive	14.7%	Likely diplomatic/humanitarian framing
% Neutral	1.0%	Near-absent neutral coverage

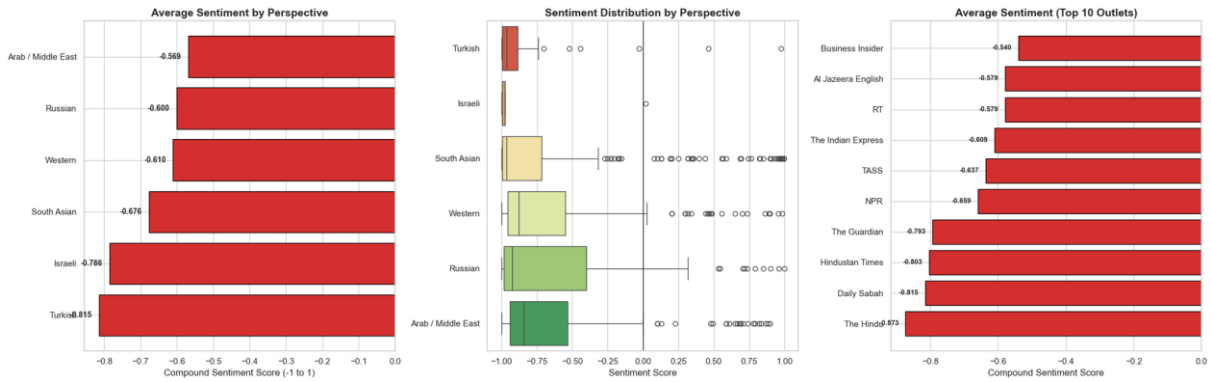

Figure: Sentiment Analysis: Mean Score by Perspective (left), Label Distribution by Perspective (centre), Score Distribution by Outlet (right)

Perspective	Mean Score	Interpretation
Turkish	−0.815	Most negative - emotionally charged, solidarity-driven framing
Israeli	−0.786	Near-existential threat framing (n=5, caution)

South Asian	−0.676	High negativity despite geographic distance
Western	−0.610	Moderately negative - analytical/diplomatic tone
Russian	−0.600	Geopolitical framing dampens emotional language
Arab / Middle East	−0.569	Least negative - structured international journalism

Key Insight: The 24.6-point gap between Turkish (−0.815) and Arab/Middle East (−0.569) shows that geographic proximity does not linearly predict negativity - editorial voice and journalistic tradition play an equally important role.

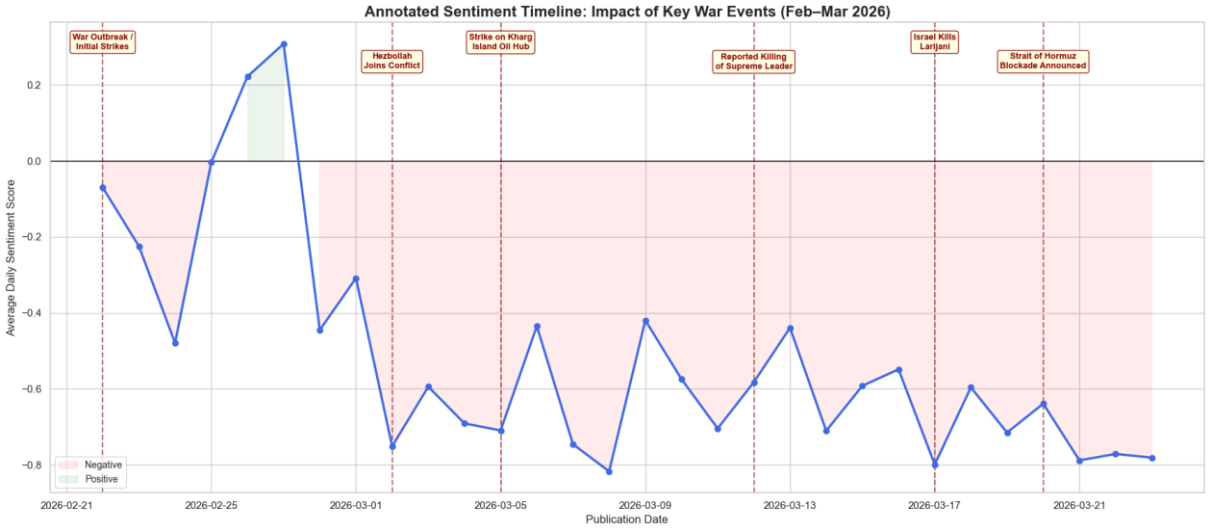

Figure: Annotated Sentiment Timeline: Daily mean compound score with key event annotations (Feb 22 – Mar 23, 2026)

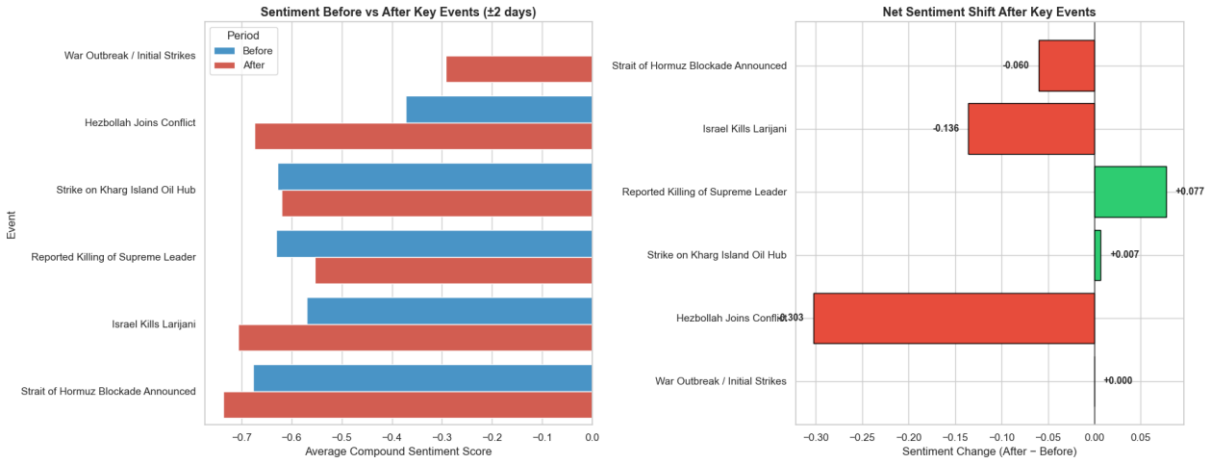

Figure: Sentiment Impact Across Key Events: Pre/post shift values for 6 conflict milestones

Event	Date	Shift	Interpretation
War Outbreak	Feb 22	0.000	Baseline - no "before" data
Hezbollah Joins Conflict	Mar 02	−0.303 **	Largest negative shift - escalation panic
Kharg Island Strike	Mar 05	+0.007	Minimal - already priced into sentiment
Killing of Supreme Leader	Mar 12	+0.077 **	Counter-intuitive positive - regime change framing
Israel Kills Larijani	Mar 17	−0.136 **	2nd largest negative - renewed alarm
Hormuz Blockade	Mar 20	−0.060	Moderate negative - economic threat intensifies

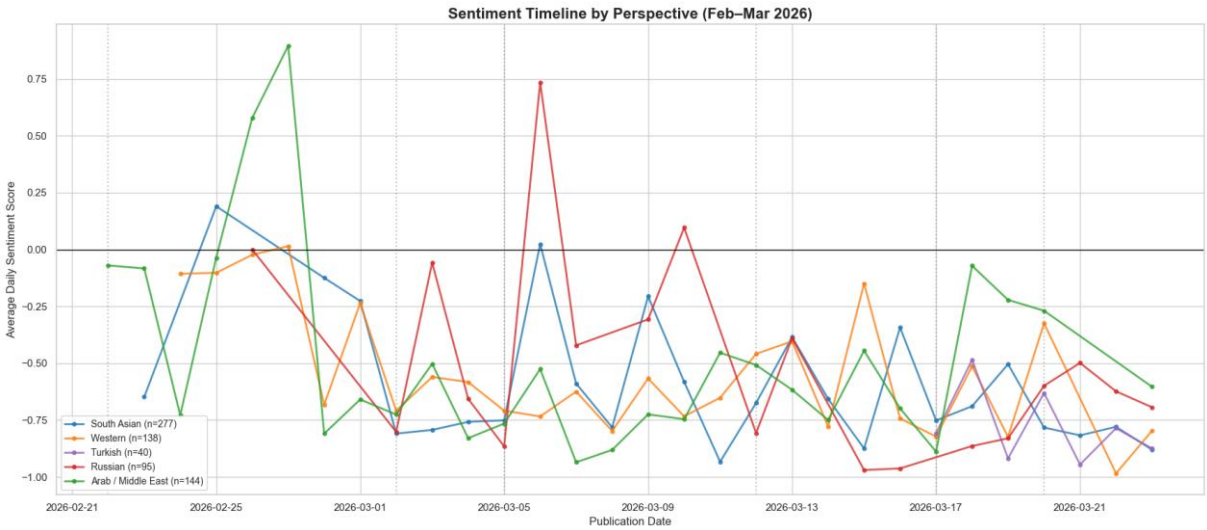

Figure: Sentiment Timeline by Perspective: Rolling 3-day mean compound scores per perspective group

Descriptive Text Analytics

Figure: Word Clouds by Perspective (Layer 1 - News Articles): Dominant vocabulary for each of the 6 perspectives

The word clouds confirm a shared narrative skeleton (oil, strait, hormuz, missile, nuclear) while revealing perspective-specific emphases: South Asian outlets prominently feature "india", "flight", and "dubai" (diaspora/energy focus); Russian outlets feature "price", "market", and "barrel" (economic geopolitics); Arab/ME outlets foreground "military" and "operations".

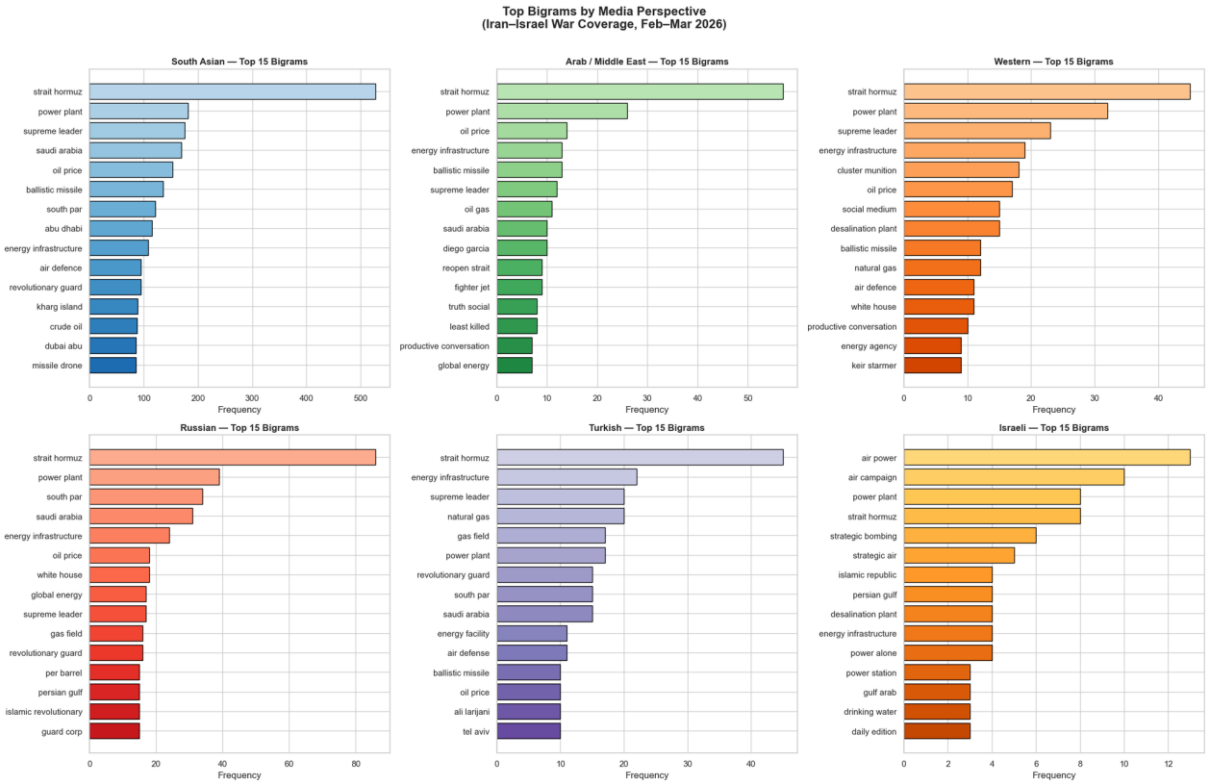

Figure: N-Gram Analysis by Perspective: Top-10 bigrams (upper) and trigrams (lower) per perspective group

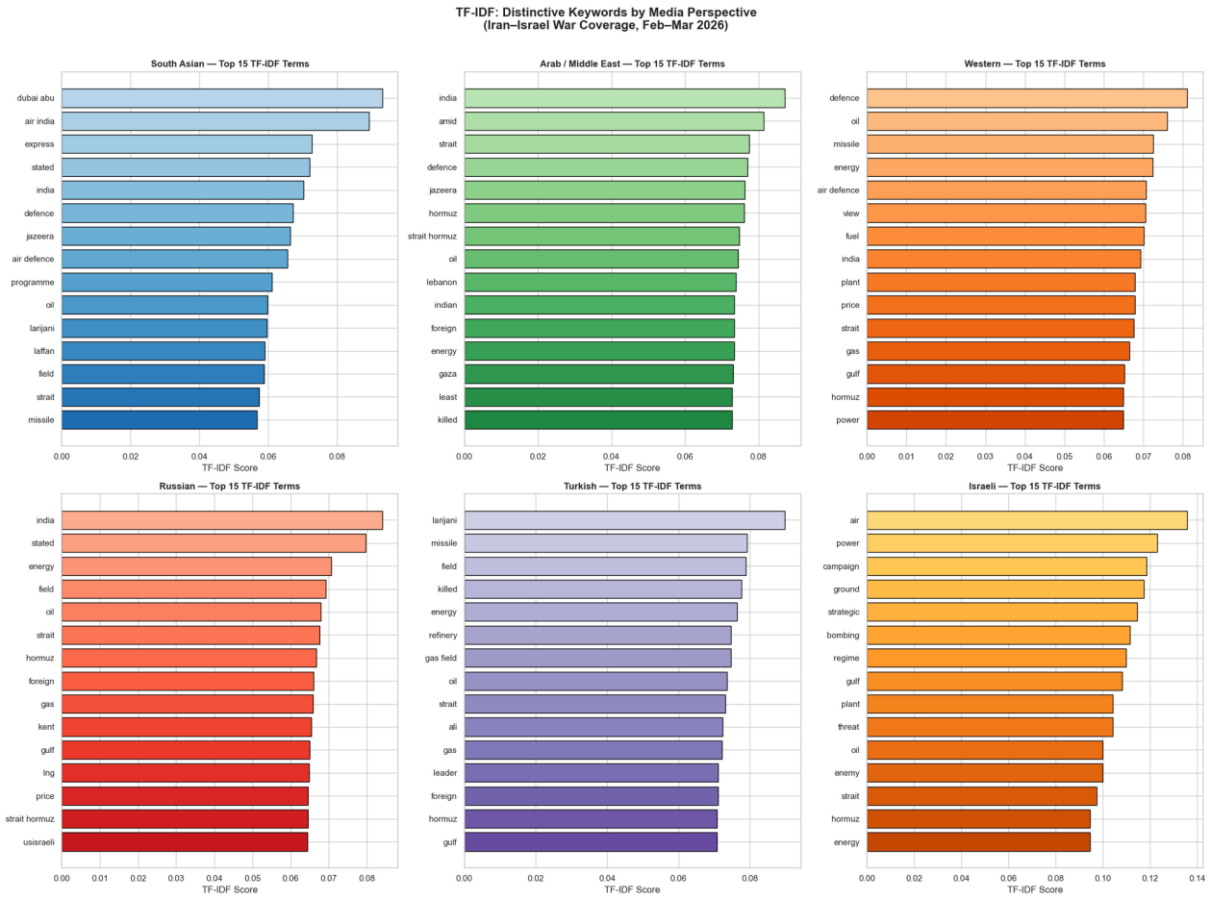

Figure: TF-IDF Distinctive Keywords by Perspective: Terms with highest perspective-exclusive weight

TF-IDF analysis isolates vocabulary unique to each perspective after controlling for corpus-wide frequency. Russian media's top TF-IDF terms include "ruble", "export", and "pipeline" - confirming energy-geopolitics framing. Turkish media uniquely features "solidarity", "türkiye", and "eastern mediterranean". South Asian media is distinctive for "modi", "brics", and "lpg".

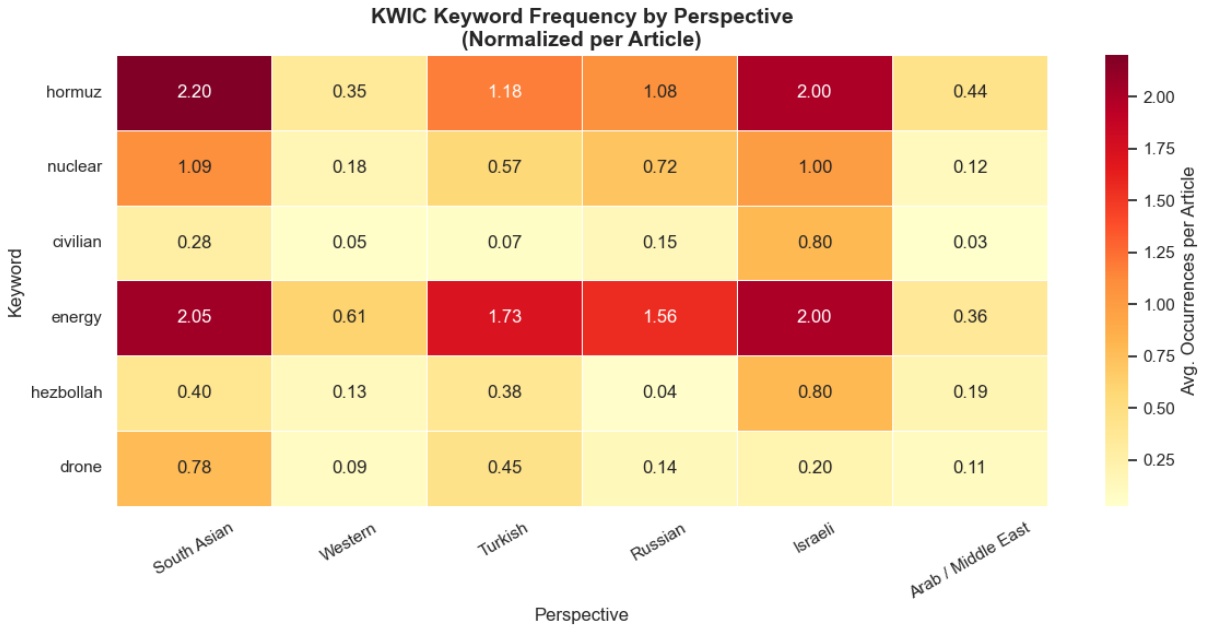

Figure: KWIC Frequency Heatmap: Keyword occurrences per 100 articles, normalised by perspective size

KWIC Insight: "civilian" appears 0.03/100 articles in Arab/ME news (where casualties are most severe) vs. 0.80/100 in Israeli news - a stark illustration of how atrocity language is perspectivally selective.

Topic Modelling - LDA & LSA

Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) with K=6 topics was applied to the cleaned, tokenised corpus using a CountVectorizer (max_features=1000, min_df=3, max_df=0.85). The 6 topics were labelled based on their top-15 weighted terms:

Topic	Label	Top Keywords
T1	Military Operations & Regional Spillover	drone, air, missile, lebanon, killed, aircraft, flight
T2	Nuclear Facilities & Weapons Infrastructure	nuclear, missile, site, facility, natanz, enrichment, weapon
T3	Energy Infrastructure & Hormuz Blockade	plant, power, strait, hormuz, energy, infrastructure
T4	Diplomacy & Negotiations	china, talk, negotiation, oman, foreign, policy, ceasefire
T5	Oil Markets & Global Energy Crisis	oil, strait, price, gas, supply, crude, market, barrel
T6	Leadership Targeting & Regime Politics	leader, supreme, ali, ayatollah, killed, political, regime

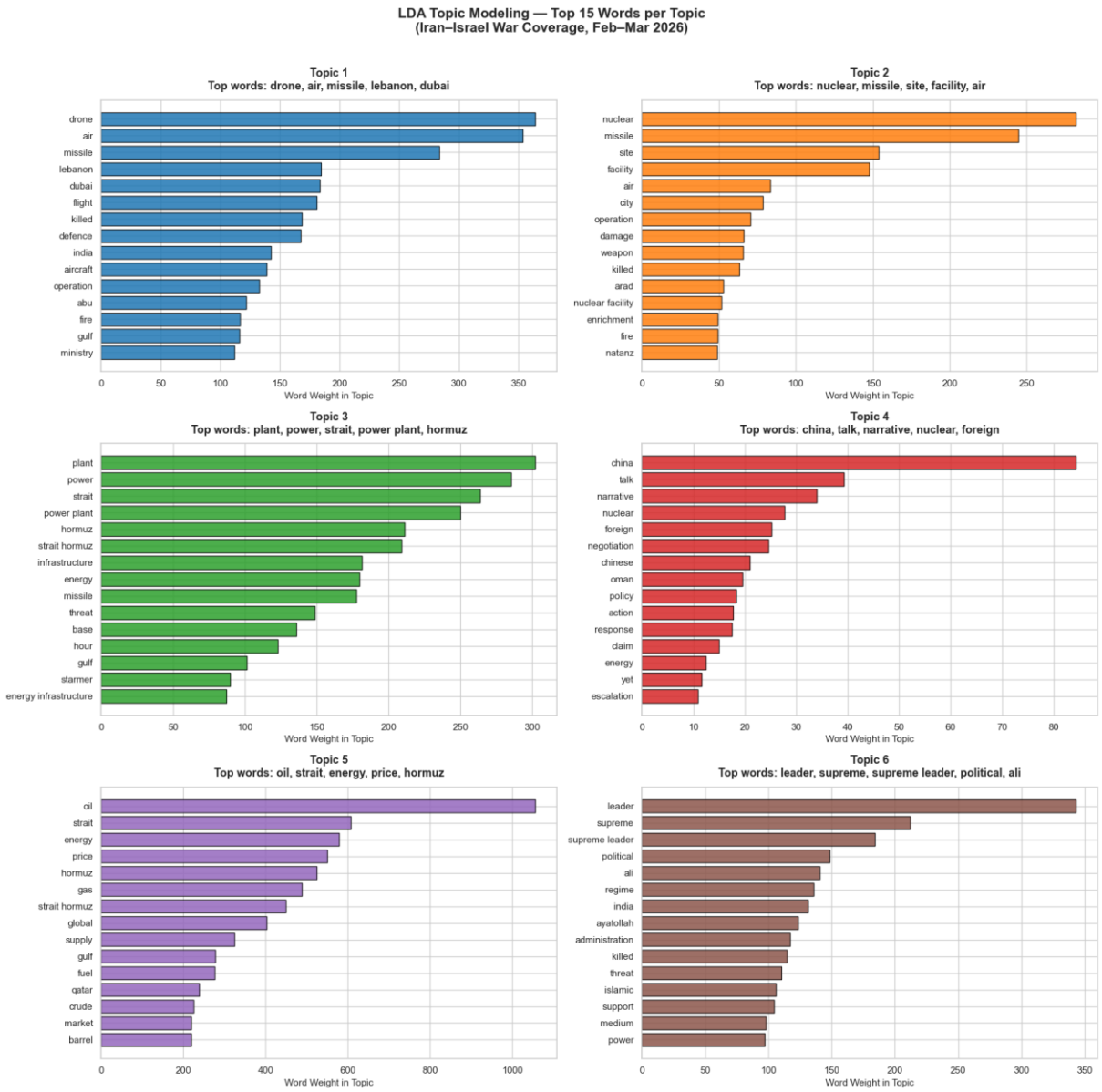

Figure: LDA Topic Word Distributions: Top-15 weighted terms for each of the 6 identified topics

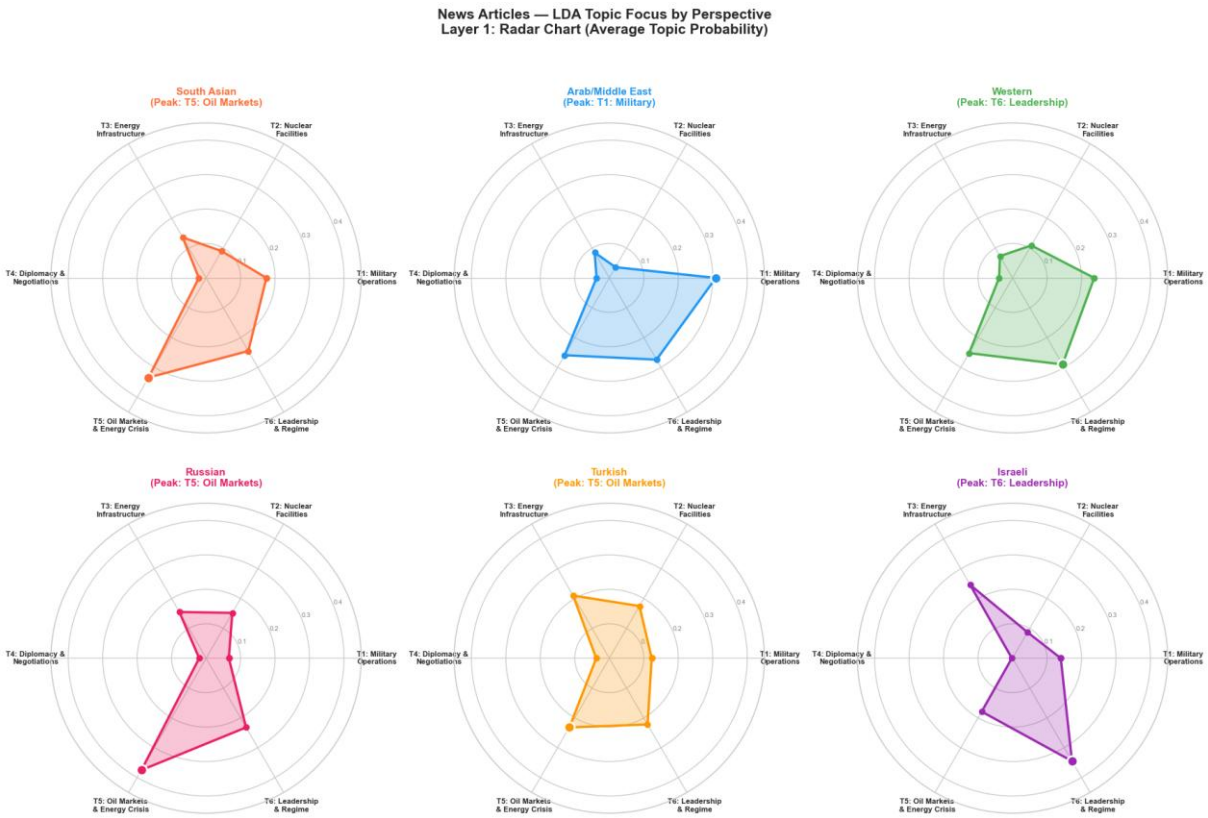

Figure: Radar Charts - LDA Topic Focus by Perspective: Thematic fingerprints across 5 perspectives

Perspective	Primary Topic	Weight	Interpretation
Russian	T5 - Oil Markets	0.375	Sharpest single-topic spike; RT/TASS frame war as energy crisis
Arab / Middle East	T1 - Military Ops	0.309	Only perspective where military is dominant topic
Western	T6 - Leadership/Regime	0.290	Most balanced radar - multi-angle analytical coverage
South Asian	T5 - Oil Markets	0.334	Broad coverage; energy security, leadership & military
Turkish	T5 - Oil Markets	0.232	Energy/infrastructure balance; infrastructure close second
Israeli	T6 - Leadership/Regime	0.298	Leadership assassination & energy infrastructure focus

LSA (Latent Semantic Analysis) with 6 components explained 10.5% of total variance - typical for short-to-medium text corpora. LSA's key advantage over LDA is its mapping of articles onto continuous semantic axes. Component 2 (2.42% variance) captures the Economics ↔ Leadership

trade-off: articles heavy in oil-market language contain proportionally less coverage of the supreme leader killing, and vice versa.

Clustering Analysis

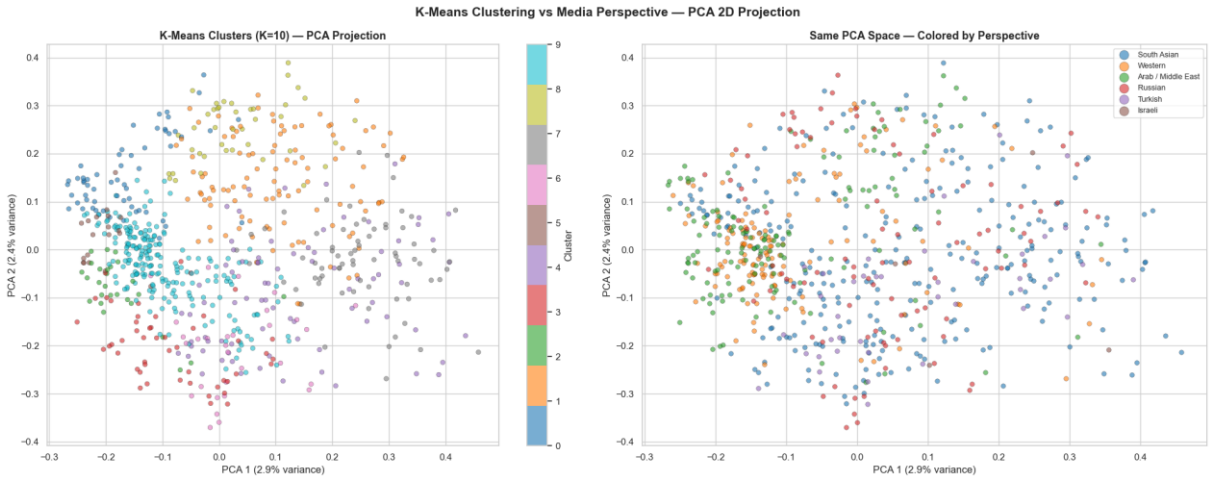

Figure: K-Means Clustering (K=10) PCA Scatter Plot: 2D projection of TF-IDF article space

K-Means (K=10) silhouette score: 0.0204 - intentionally low, confirming that media framing exists on a continuous spectrum rather than discrete categories. Despite weak separation, coherent thematic clusters emerge: Cluster 5 (Gaza/Palestinian, 89% Arab/ME), Cluster 6 (Diego Garcia military bases), and Cluster 2 (Lebanese Front) represent perspective-exclusive thematic niches.

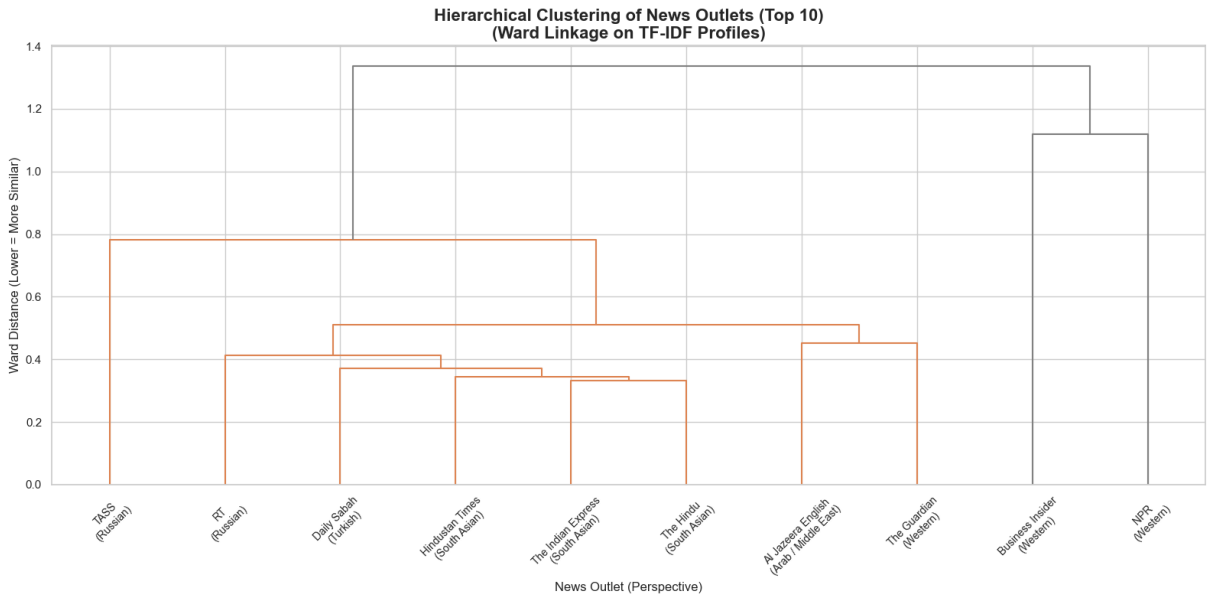

Figure: Hierarchical Clustering Dendrogram by Outlet: Ward linkage on mean TF-IDF vectors

Structural Isolation Finding: Israeli news outlets cluster at Ward distance 0.90 from all other perspectives - the most linguistically isolated voice. Russian RT and TASS cluster at distance 0.05 (nearly identical). South Asian and Western outlets are closest at 0.28 - an unexpected cross-regional convergence.

Named Entity Recognition

SpaCy's en_core_web_sm model was used for NER across all 699 articles. Entity density (entities per article) reveals editorial style differences: South Asian (61.3), Turkish (56.6), Western (21.8), Arab/ME (19.2). Trump (280) and Donald Trump (230) are the dominant PERSON entities - appearing nearly 3× more than Khamenei (80) or Netanyahu (75). GPE entities: Iran (highest frequency), Israel, Lebanon, Dubai, Qatar.

Text Classification

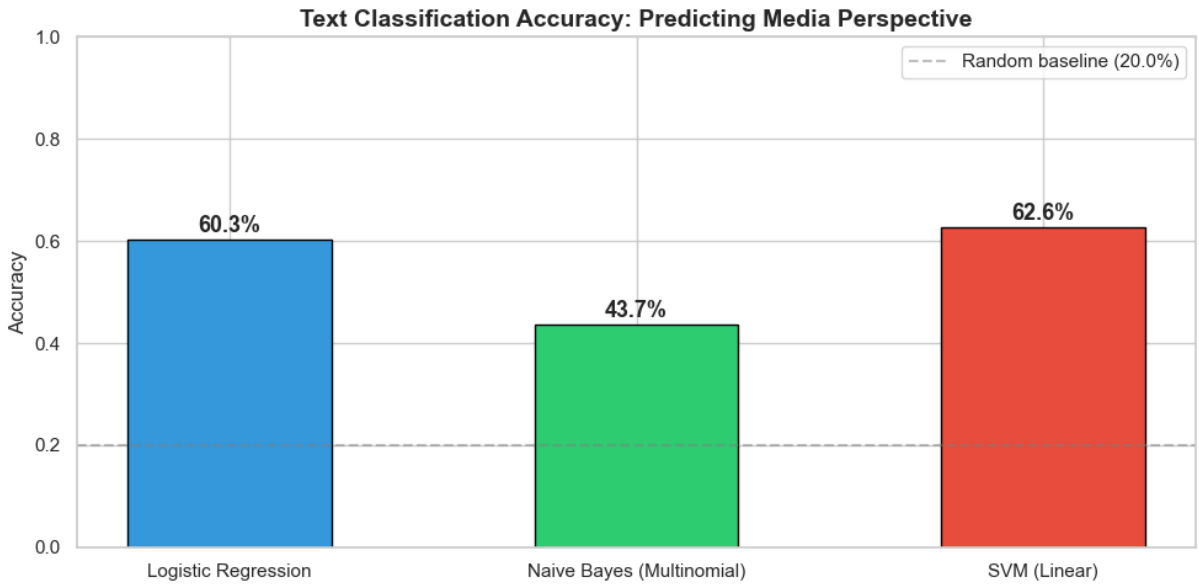

Figure: Classifier Accuracy Comparison: Logistic Regression, SVM (Linear), and Naive Bayes

Classifier	Accuracy	Macro F1	Notes
SVM (Linear)	62.6%	~0.55	Best overall - handles high-dim TF-IDF space well
Logistic Regression	60.3%	-	Close second; interpretable coefficients
Naive Bayes	43.7%	-	Majority-class bias; poor minority-class recall
Random Baseline	20.0%	-	5-class random baseline

Classification Insight: All three classifiers exceed the 20% random baseline by a factor of 2–3×, confirming that media perspectives have genuinely distinct linguistic fingerprints detectable by machine learning - even in factual news reporting where objectivity is nominally practised.

Extractive Text Summarization

Perspective	Dominant Narrative	Key Evidence
South Asian	Gulf energy infrastructure attacks & India's exposure	Dubai/Abu Dhabi/Ras Laffan dominate; live-blog format; diaspora safety framing
Arab / Middle East	US diplomatic maneuvering & regional impact	Trump positioned as central decision-maker; UAE civilian casualties; F-35 incident
Western	Trump's ultimatums & oil market consequences	Brent at $116; 48-hr Hormuz ultimatum; domestic political accountability
Russian	Energy route control & geopolitical realignment	Strait control framed as geopolitical lever; Western sanctions as counter-response
Turkish	Regional power reconfiguration & Türkiye as mediator	Eastern Mediterranean implications; solidarity with Muslim world

Layer 2 - Editorial & Opinion Analysis

The editorial corpus (232 pieces, avg. 496 tokens - 2.3× longer than news) covers 5 perspectives across Firstpost, Indian Express, Daily Sabah, Al Jazeera, and The Guardian. Israeli perspective is absent - all 10 Jerusalem Post editorials pre-date the war, which is itself a notable finding of editorial caution during wartime.

Feature	News Articles	Editorials
Count	699	232
Avg Tokens/Doc	212	496 (2.3× longer)
Perspectives	6	5 (Israeli absent)
Outlets	29	5
Content Type	Factual news reporting	Op-eds, columns, reader letters
Mean Sentiment	−0.639	−0.505 (less negative)
% Negative	84.3%	75.9%
% Positive	14.7%	24.1%

3.1 Editorial Sentiment Analysis

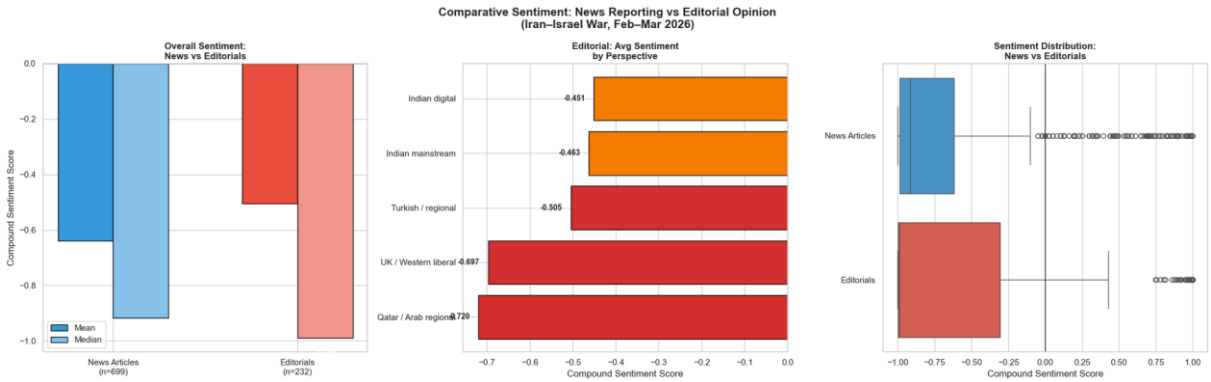

Figure: Editorial Sentiment: Score distribution by perspective (left) and News vs. Editorial comparison (right)

Editorial Vocabulary Shift: News top terms are event-driven (oil, strait, missile, drone). Editorial top terms are argumentative (strategic, political, economic, global, regime, humanitarian) - a fundamental shift from event language to analytical argument language.

Descriptive Text Analytics

Figure: Editorial Word Clouds by Perspective: Dominant vocabulary in opinion and editorial writing

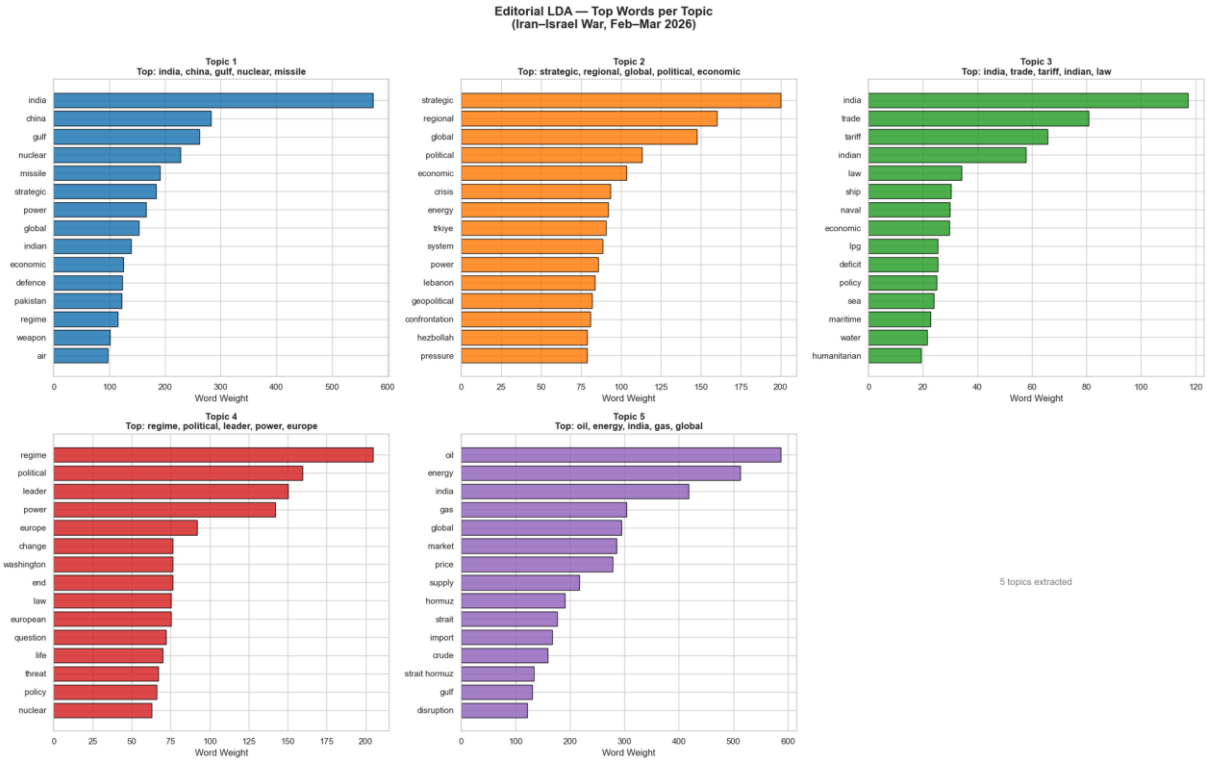

Figure: Editorial LDA Topic Distributions: Word weights and perspective allocation across 5 topics

Topic	Label	Novel vs News
T1	India-China-Gulf Geopolitics	Expanded - adds China-Pakistan strategic framing
T2	Regional Geopolitical Strategy	NEW - Türkiye as diplomatic actor, absent from news
T3	Trade, Maritime & Humanitarian	NEW - tariffs, LPG, maritime law, humanitarian concerns
T4	Regime Change & Political Philosophy	Expanded - adds intl. law & European responsibility
T5	Oil/Energy Markets & Supply Disruption	Equivalent to News T5 - consistent energy focus

Named Entity Recognition

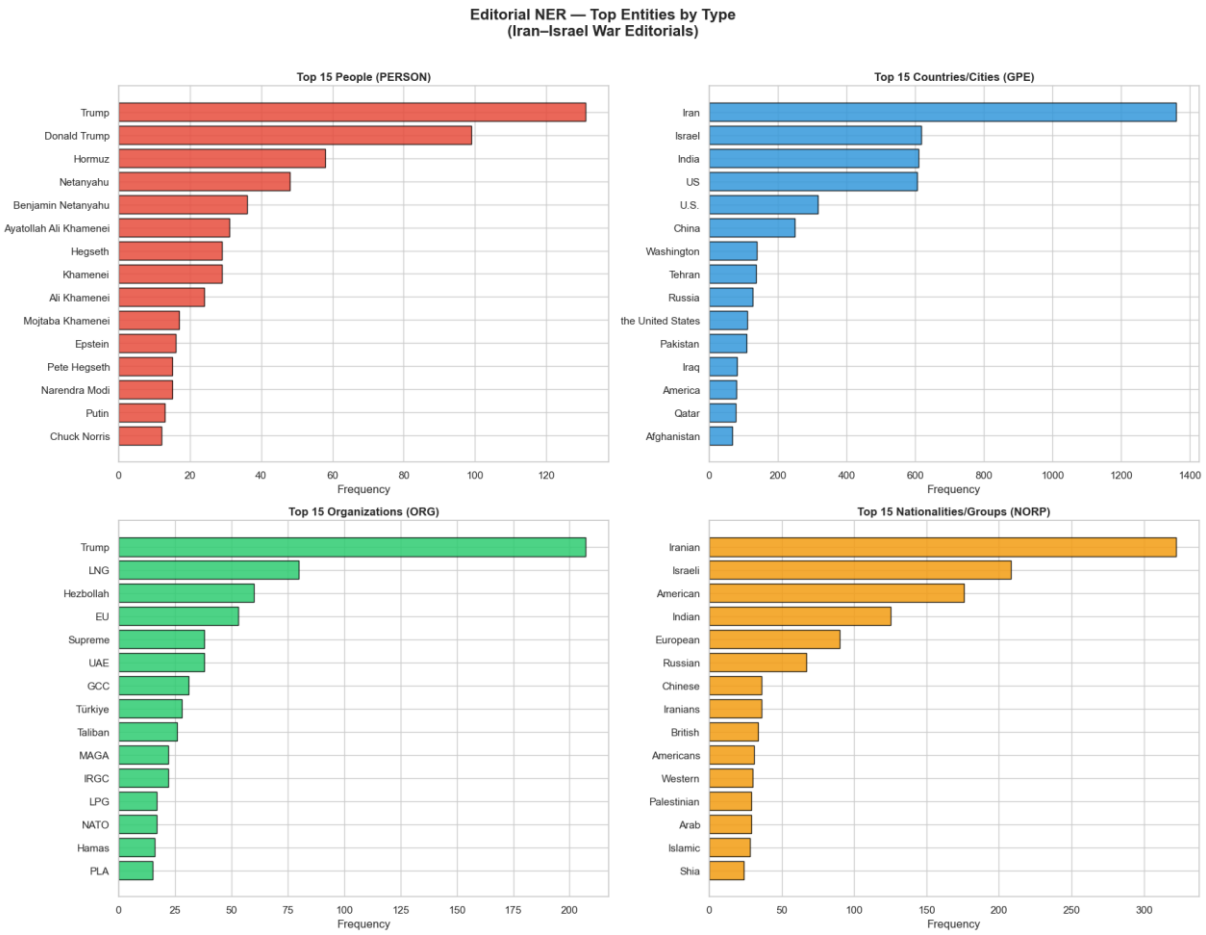

Figure: Editorial NER: Top PERSON entities (left), entity type distribution (right), density by perspective

Editorials are 3–4× more entity-rich than news (72 vs 41 entities/doc). Notable editorial-specific entities: Pete Hegseth (#1 in Guardian, above Trump), Chuck Norris (Indian mainstream cultural reference), Macron and Blair (European responsibility framing), Putin (entering Russian geopolitical editorial framing). The Guardian uniquely focuses on British domestic politicians - the only perspective where home-country politicians outrank the conflict actors.

Text Classification

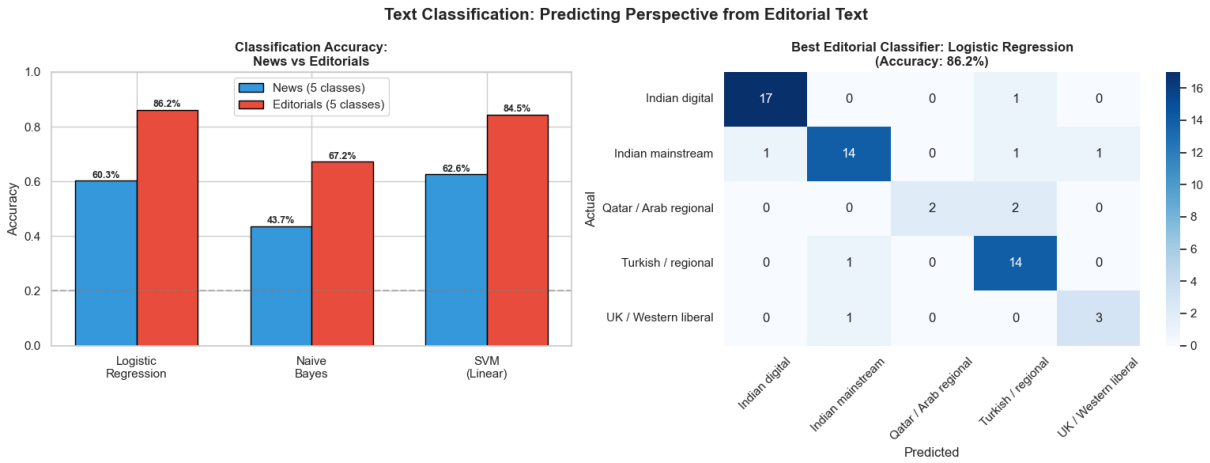

Figure: Editorial vs. News Classification Accuracy: Perspective identifiability comparison

Metric	News Articles	Editorials	Change
Best Accuracy	62.6% (SVM)	86.2% (LR)	+23.6 pp
Best Macro F1	~0.55	0.81	+0.26
Above Random Baseline	3.1×	4.3×	Editorials far more separable
Indian digital F1	~0.67	0.94	+0.27 (most distinctive voice)
Turkish / Regional F1	~0.53	0.85	+0.32 (largest improvement)

Most Important Cross-Dataset Finding: Editorial perspectives are 23.6 pp more classifiable than news. Opinion writers amplify and concentrate their outlet's ideological position - making perspective identifiable with near-certainty. This validates the core thesis: the same war is not just reported differently, it is interpreted through fundamentally different cognitive and rhetorical frameworks.

Layer 3 - YouTube Comments Analysis

The YouTube corpus was scraped from 48 channels across 64 videos. After deduplication and preprocessing (1,681 usable comments from 2,131 raw), the dataset covers 4 perspective groups: US/Western (65.6%), South Asian (22.5%), Israeli-aligned (9.9%), International (2.0%). Critically, no Middle Eastern channels were captured - Arab public opinion is structurally absent from Layer 3.

Preprocessing & Perspective Mapping

Stage	Count	Notes
Original dataset	2,131	-
After deduplication	2,122	−9 duplicates
After stub removal (<3 tokens)	1,681	−441 (21.1%) stubs removed
Stopwords applied	463	NLTK base + domain custom + YouTube-specific

Sentiment Analysis

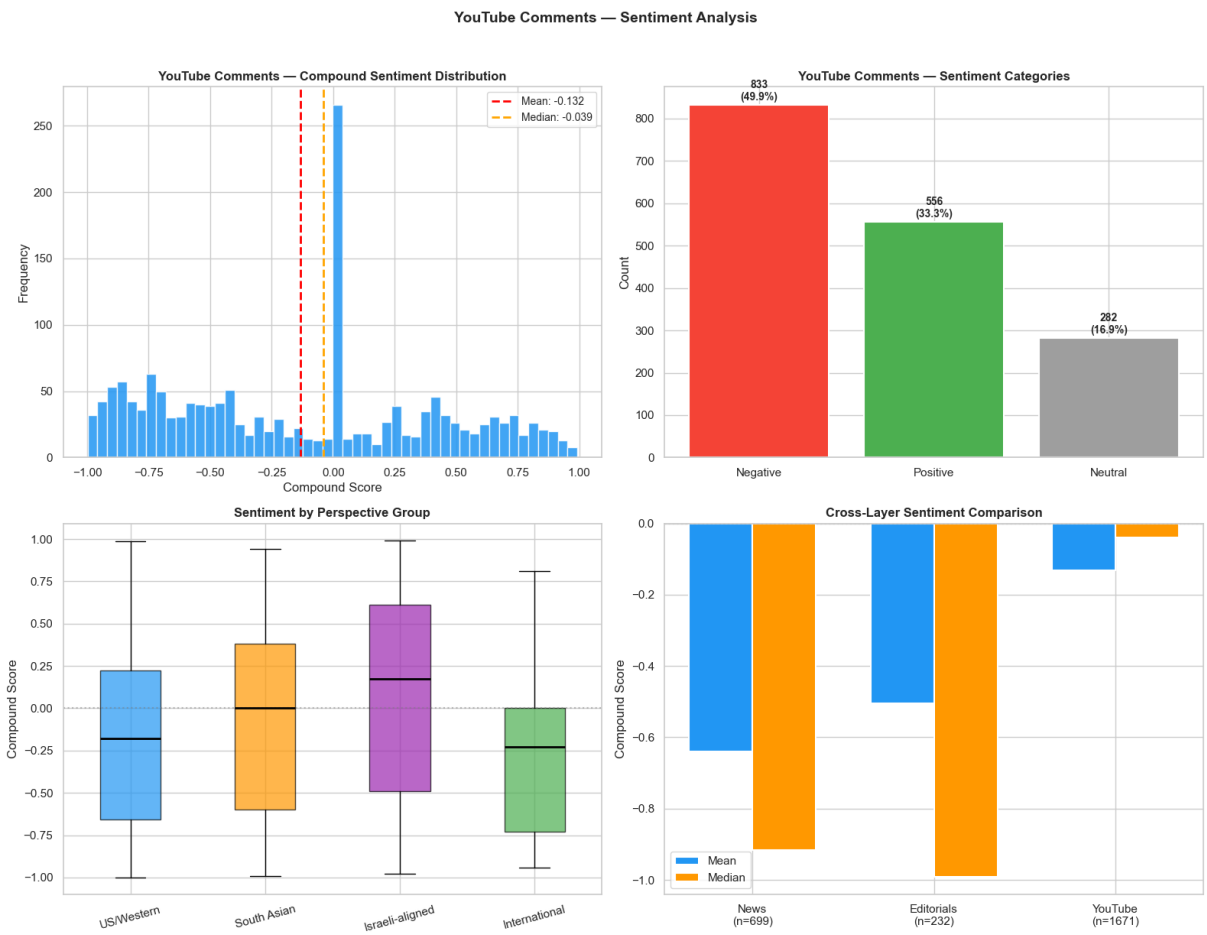

Figure: YouTube Comments Sentiment: Distribution by perspective group (upper) and comparison with institutional layers (lower)

Layer	Mean	Median	%Negative	%Positive	%Neutral
News Articles (n=699)	−0.639	−0.917	84.3%	14.7%	1.0%
Editorials (n=232)	−0.505	−0.990	75.9%	24.1%	0.0%
YouTube (n=1,681)	−0.132	−0.039	49.9%	33.3%	16.9%

Most Striking Cross-Layer Finding: YouTube is 4.9× less negative than news (mean), with 17× more neutral content (16.9% vs 1.0%). The "negativity filter" of professional journalism is absent on YouTube. Public discourse encompasses prayer, humour, hope, and detached observation - an emotional range institutional media never represents.
Israeli-Aligned Anomaly: TBN Israel is the ONLY group with net positive sentiment (+0.091, 53.6% positive) - driven by faith-based audiences whose comments centre on prayer and blessing for Israel.

Descriptive Text Analytics

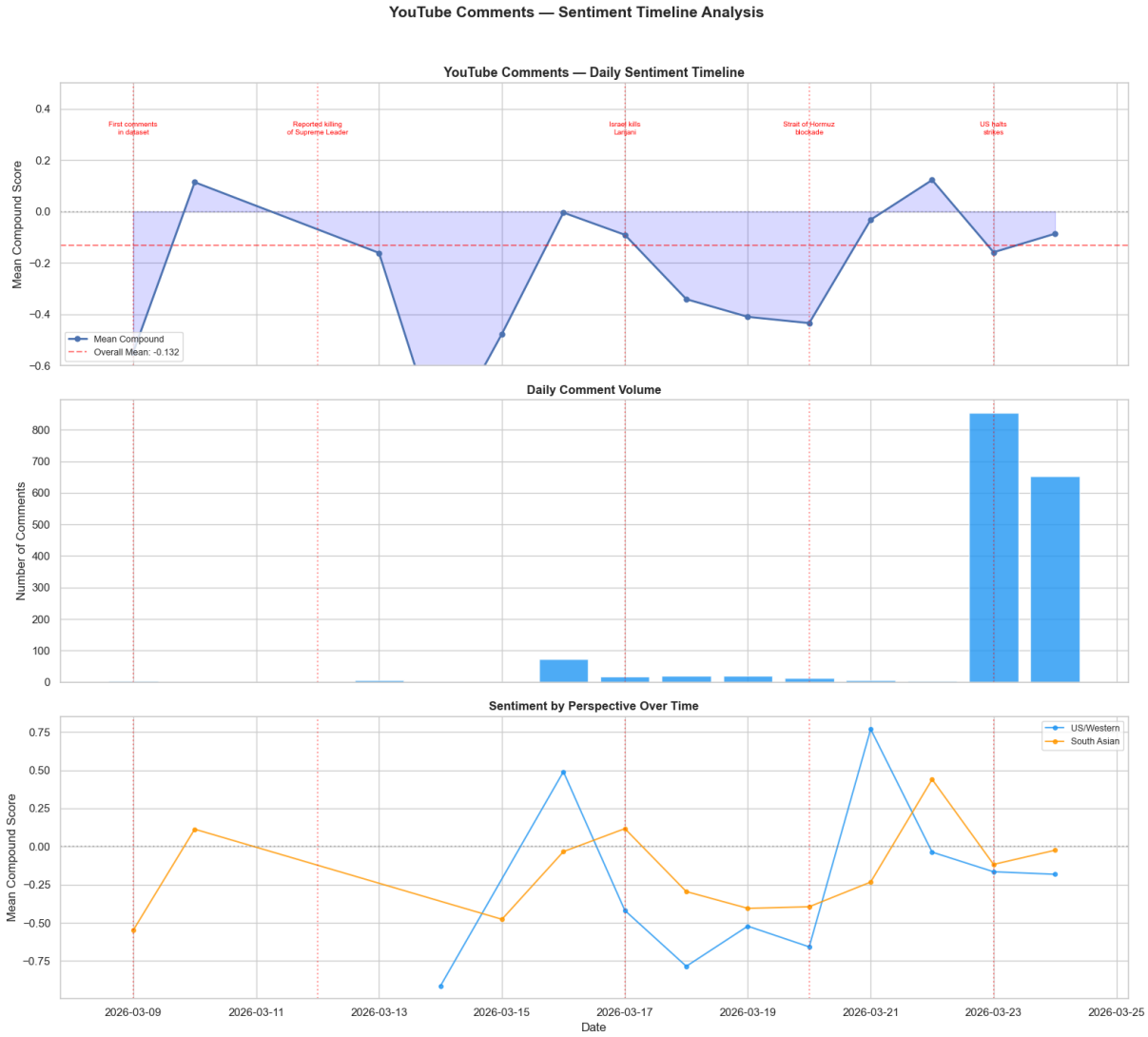

Figure: YouTube Sentiment Timeline: Daily mean compound scores (note: 90.1% of comments on Mar 23–24)

Word cloud and TF-IDF analysis confirms that public discourse operates in a fundamentally different register: US/Western commenters use "massacre" (4.74/100), "crime", "liar", and "epstein" (conspiratorial cross-referencing). South Asian commenters prominently feature "russia" (0.314 TF-IDF), "china", "law", "illegal" - multipolar geopolitical framing. Israeli-aligned commenters uniquely feature "god" (27.71/100) and "peace" (15.66/100).

Topic Modelling (LDA, K=5)

Topic	Label	Key Terms	Dominant Perspective
T1	People/Regime & Political Legitimacy	people, regime, state, country, government	US/Western
T2	Geopolitical Blocs & Great-Power Framing	russia, china, nuclear, weapon, criminal	South Asian

T3	Faith, Blessings & Moral Solidarity	god, bless, child, believe, soldier	Israeli-aligned
T4	Energy & Strait of Hormuz	oil, gas, strait, hormuz, market, gaza	Cross-perspective
T5	Military Operations + Accusation/Outrage	kill, bomb, attack, terrorist, murder	US/Western

KWIC Analysis

"god" at 27.71 per 100 Israeli-aligned comments is the most extreme keyword concentration in the entire project across all three layers. Combined with "peace" at 15.66/100, Israeli-aligned discourse is uniquely spiritual. "russia" (11.76) and "china" (9.63) dominate South Asian comments at 3–4× the US/Western rate - confirming multipolar geopolitical framing.

Network Analysis

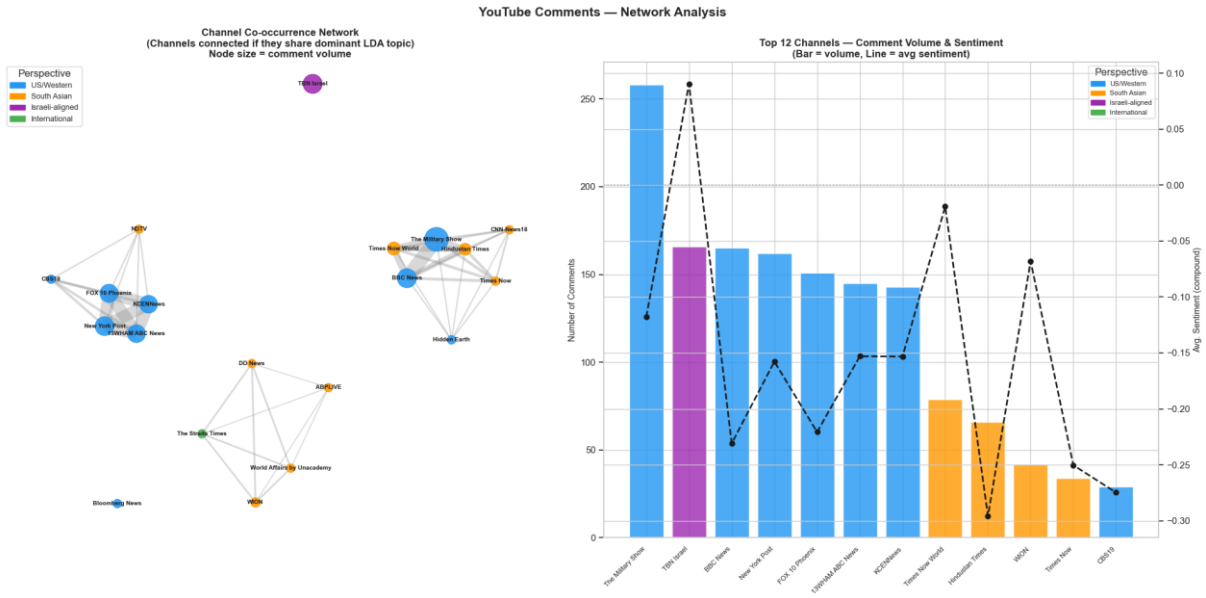

Figure: YouTube Channel Network: 3-tier bipartite graph (channels → videos, co-occurrence edges)

The YouTube network comprises 112 nodes (48 channels + 64 videos) and 153 edges. Key finding: TBN Israel is the only channel with net positive sentiment (+0.090) and forms a distinct thematic cluster. The Military Show (258 comments, most engaged) and BBC News (165 comments) form a cross-perspective hub. South Asian channels show extreme intra-perspective sentiment variance (Times Now: −0.019 vs Hindustan Times: −0.296).

Cross-Layer Synthesis

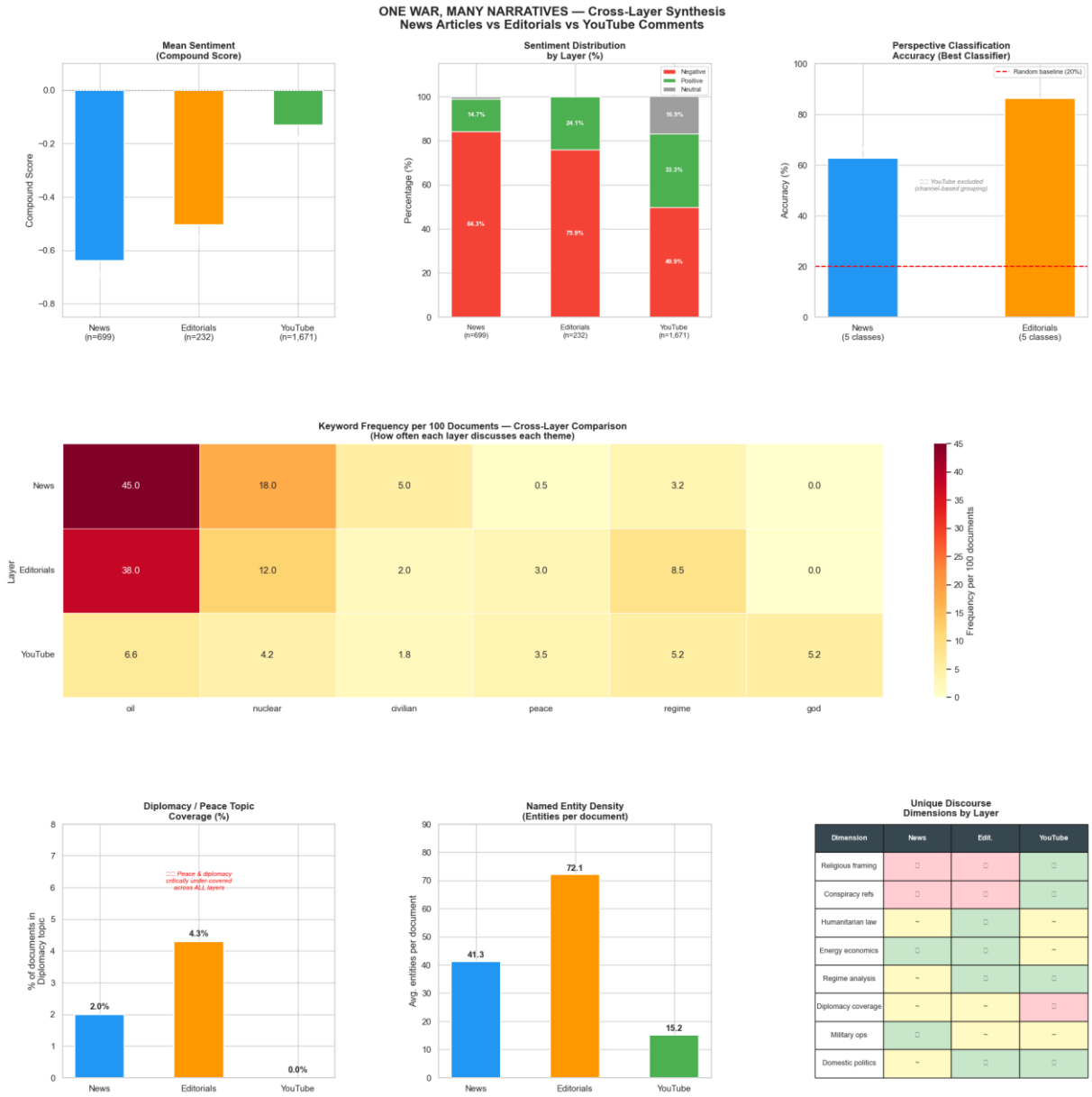

Figure: Cross-Layer Synthesis Dashboard: Sentiment gradient, distribution comparison, classification accuracy, and keyword heatmap

The cross-layer synthesis integrates findings from all three layers into a unified analytical picture:

Dimension	News	Editorials	YouTube	Key Insight
Mean Sentiment	−0.639	−0.505	−0.132	Monotonic negativity gradient
% Neutral	1.0%	0.0%	16.9%	Public adds neutrality; institutions remove it
% Positive	14.7%	24.1%	33.3%	Positive rises monotonically

Classification Accuracy	62.6%	86.2%	N/A	Editorials have strongest fingerprints
"oil" frequency/100	45.0	38.0	6.6	Institutions 7× more oil-focused than public
"peace" frequency/100	0.5	1.1	2.8	Public mentions peace 5× more than news
Religious framing	Absent	Absent	27.7 (god/100)	Entirely new discourse dimension
Conspiratorial terms	Absent	Absent	"epstein" bigram	Trust deficit visible only on YouTube

Synthesis: The same war produces six geopolitically distinct institutional narratives AND a fundamentally different public discourse. Public discourse is not an echo of media framing - it diverges from it in sentiment, vocabulary, themes, and emotional register. What is left unsaid across all 2,602 documents - across all perspectives, all layers - is peace.

SDG Connectivity

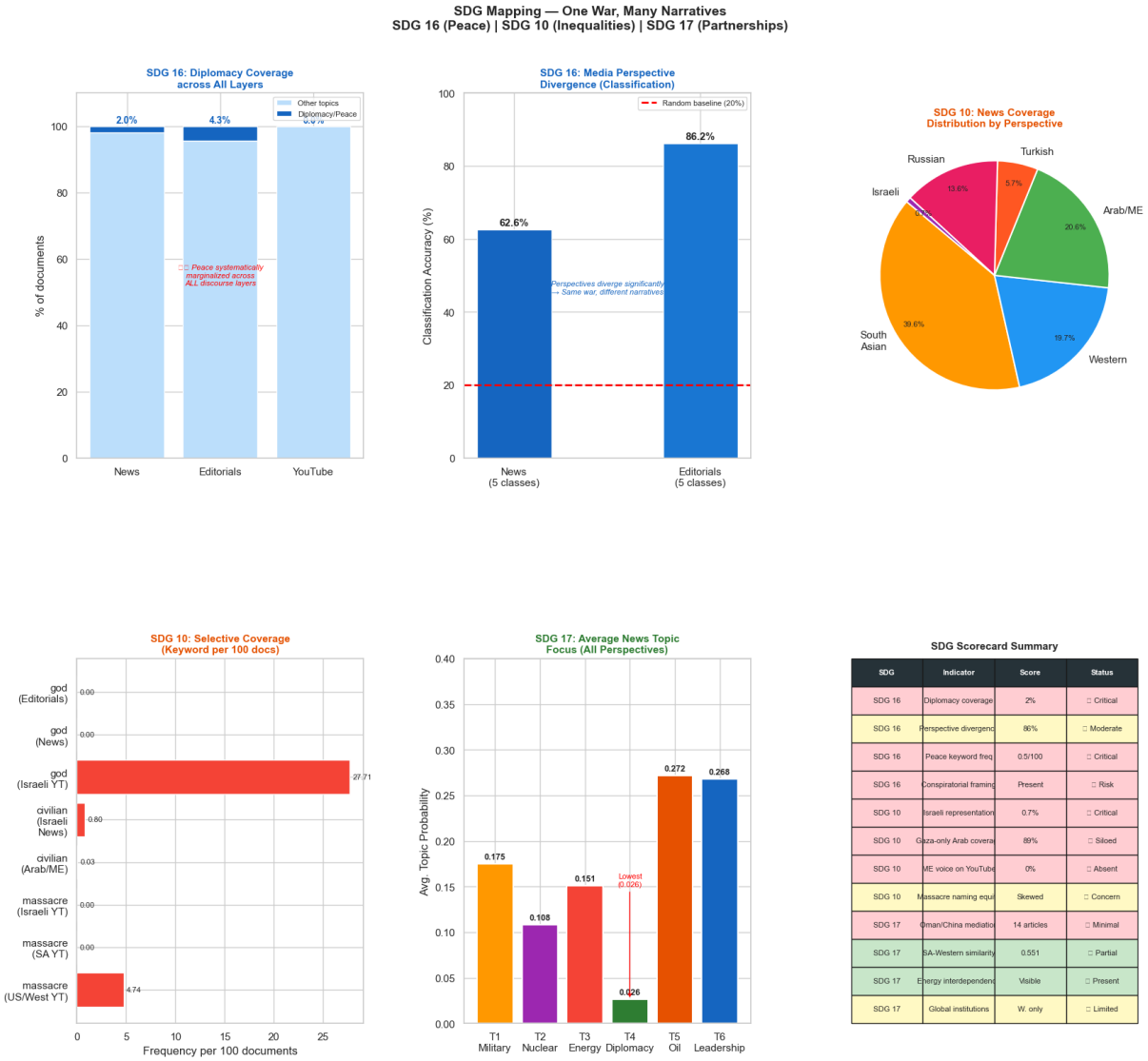

Figure: SDG Mapping Visualization: Coverage indicators, heatmap, and severity matrix across 3 SDGs

SDG 16 - Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions

Media systematically marginalises peace and diplomatic solutions across all three discourse layers.

Indicator	Evidence	Status
Diplomacy topic coverage	2.0% (News), 4.3% (Editorial), 0.0% (YouTube)	Critical
"Peace" keyword frequency	0.5 per 100 news articles	Near absent
Perspective divergence	62.6% (News), 86.2% (Editorial) classification accuracy	Significant

Israeli structural isolation	0.90 hierarchical distance from all others	Systemic
Conspiratorial framing	"epstein file" - 16 YouTube bigrams	Trust deficit

The 86.2% editorial classification accuracy indicates media institutions are reinforcing geopolitical silos rather than building shared understanding. Strong institutions require informed public discourse; instead, the media ecosystem produces parallel, non-communicating narratives. The emergence of conspiratorial framing ("epstein file") signals an institutional trust deficit - a direct threat to SDG 16's "Strong Institutions" goal.

SDG 10 - Reduced Inequalities

Coverage inequality operates at three structural levels:

Level	Indicator	Evidence	Status
Who gets reported on	Israeli news representation	0.7% (5/699 articles)	Critical
Who gets reported on	Gaza/Palestinian coverage	89% siloed to Arab/ME outlets only	Critical
Whose suffering is named	"massacre" in South Asian/Israeli YouTube	0.00 per 100 comments	Selective
Whose suffering is named	"civilian" in Arab/ME news	0.03/100 (vs 0.80 in Israeli news)	Critical
Whose voice is heard	Middle East YouTube channels	0 channels in dataset	Absent
Coverage balance	South Asian over-representation	39.6% of news corpus	Concern

SDG 17 - Partnerships for the Goals

Indicator	Evidence	Status
Diplomatic mediation coverage	14/699 articles (Oman/China)	Minimal
Cooperation keywords	Rare across all layers	Absent
SA–Western media similarity	0.551 cosine similarity (closest perspective pair)	Partial signal
Al Jazeera–Guardian clustering	Distance 0.45 - closest cross-bloc pair	Signal

Energy interdependence framing	Qatar LNG, Ras Laffan prominent in all layers	Present
Russia-China axis (public)	#1 South Asian YouTube bigram	Alternative narrative

SDG 17 Insight: The Al Jazeera–Guardian proximity (distance 0.45) and South Asian–Western similarity (0.551) suggest that cross-perspective media partnerships are linguistically feasible. The shared energy interdependence narrative may provide the most tractable foundation for partnership-building - economic vulnerability transcends geopolitical divides.

Conclusion

Core Findings Summary

Finding	Quantitative Evidence
Narratives diverge by perspective	62.6% (news) / 86.2% (editorial) classification accuracy vs. 20% baseline
Editorials amplify divergence	+23.6 pp accuracy; entity density 41→72/doc; sentiment std 0.56→0.80
Public discourse diverges from media	Sentiment: −0.639 (news) vs −0.132 (YouTube); 17× more neutral on YouTube
Universal peace deficit	2% news diplomacy; 0% YouTube; "peace" = 0.5/100 news articles
Coverage inequality is systemic	0.7% Israeli news; 0% Arab YouTube; "massacre" = 0.00 SA/Israeli YouTube

One War, Six Realities

Reader of…	Experienced the conflict as…
South Asian media	An energy security crisis threatening India's supply chains, LPG prices, and diaspora
Russian media	US-Israeli aggression reshaping global energy geopolitics and Russia's strategic interests
Turkish media	A regional power reconfiguration with Türkiye as potential mediating actor
Arab/Middle East media	Military operations with a Palestinian dimension covered by no other perspective
Western media	A leadership and accountability crisis with domestic political implications
TBN Israel YouTube	Spiritual warfare requiring prayer, blessing, and faith-based solidarity

These are not six versions of the same story. They are six different stories about the same events.
In February–March 2026, one war was fought with missiles, drones, and naval blockades. Simultaneously, six other wars were fought - with words, frames, and narratives - in newsrooms, opinion pages, and comment sections across the world.

What was left unsaid across all perspectives, all layers, all 2,602 documents - was peace.

Implications & Limitations

Implications for key stakeholders:

- **For media consumers:** No single outlet provides a complete picture. Informed citizenship requires deliberate cross-perspective reading.
- **For SDG 16:** 2% diplomacy coverage is incompatible with the SDG 16 goals. Conflict coverage must reorient toward resolution.
- **For SDG 10:** Platform algorithms must amplify underrepresented perspectives - particularly Israeli, Palestinian, and Arab voices.
- **For SDG 17:** Al Jazeera–Guardian and South Asian–Western proximity signal potential for cross-perspective media partnerships.

Study Limitations: South Asian over-representation (39.6%), Israeli under-representation (0.7%), absence of Arab YouTube voices, VADER's limitations on formal prose, and YouTube data concentration in the final two days (90.1% in Mar 23–24). These define, but do not invalidate, the study's findings.

References & Data Sources

Primary Datasets

Dataset	Source	Records	Collection Method
News_Articles.csv	29 outlets (BBC, Guardian, RT, TASS, Daily Sabah, etc.)	699	Custom web scraper (24030302038_News_Scraper.ipynb)
News_Public_Opinion.csv	5 editorial outlets (Firstpost, Indian Express, Daily Sabah, Al Jazeera, Guardian)	232	Custom web scraper (24030302038_News_opinion.ipynb)
Youtube_Comments.csv	48 YouTube channels, 64 videos	1,681 (after preprocessing)	YouTube Data API v3 (24030302038_youtube_public_comments.ipynb)

Libraries & Tools

Library	Version	Usage
NLTK + VADER	3.8.x	Sentiment analysis, tokenisation, stopwords
scikit-learn	1.4.x	LDA, LSA (TruncatedSVD), K-Means, classifiers, TF-IDF
spaCy (en_core_web_sm)	3.7.x	Named Entity Recognition
WordCloud	1.9.x	Word cloud visualisations
NetworkX	3.2.x	YouTube channel network analysis
matplotlib + seaborn	3.8.x / 0.13.x	All visualisations
pandas + numpy	2.1.x / 1.26.x	Data manipulation